The Jungle Book was written by Rudyard Kipling. The book has attracted audiences of all ages for its plot structure and characters. Children especially enjoy this story as it deals with the early childhood of a boy in the midst of wild animals in the forest.

Characters


Father Wolf


Mother Wolf


Tabaqui


Shere Khan


Narrator

Father Wolf, Mother Wolf, Tabaqui (the Jackal), Shere Khan (the Tiger), Man's Cub (Mowgli), Wolf's Cubs, Narrator

Scene I

The scene opens in the Seeonee Hills. It's seven o'clock, a sunny evening, in the middle of the jungle. The Moon is yet to rise and with no stars to brighten the sky, utter darkness surrounds the forest.


: Father Wolf wakes up from his day's rest, releases and spreads out his paws one after the other to make himself ready for the hunt. Mother Wolf with her big grey nose drops her four tumbling, squealing cubs into the mouth of the cave where they all live.


: Augrh! It is time to hunt again. (Moves down to spring downhill, where he notices a little shadow with a bushy tail at the entrance and whines)


: Good Luck go with you, O! chief of the Wolves. And good luck and strong white teeth go with noble children that they may never forget the hungry in this world.


: *(In a stiff tone)* Enter, then, and look, but there is no food here.


: For a wolf it may not be enough, but for so mean a person as myself a dry bone is a good feast.

All thanks for this good meal *(licking his lips)*.

(Looks at the Father and Mother Wolf who seem to be uncomfortable)

How beautiful are the noble children! How large are their eyes! And so young too!

(Sits still, rejoicing in the mischief that he had made. In a spiteful tone he says) Shere Khan, the Big one has shifted his hunting grounds. He has told me that he will hunt among these hills for the next moon.


: Shere Khan was the tiger who lived near the Waingunga River, twenty miles away.

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